

Eager to not serve

Dear Vinit,
Your December editorial hit the nail on the head—most of the companies in India, even multi-nationals, have taken the law in their hands and are only interested in selling their products: once an item is sold, the customer no longer exists for them. Cheers to you for raising this issue. I hope it will make companies get up and take a long hard look at their service policies.

Trevor
Via e-mail

digit

Hi Trevor,
Yes, companies still take their customers for granted. And what bothers me most is that their frontline support personnel, who interface directly with their customers, are often the weakest links in the organisational chain. Also things get trickier in a country like ours where we don't have a 'working' mechanism of seeking compensation. Hopefully more and more companies will awaken to the fact that providing value to their customers is the only thing that

Credit overdue

Dear Vinit,
In the news article titled 'What's in a Name?' in the November 2002 issue, Linux was addressed as "Linus Torvalds' operating system" and you mentioned that Richard Stallman wants it to be 'renamed' as GNU/Linux. The OS we know today as Linux was born out of the GNU project, conceived by Stallman in 1984. It is very strange how Torvalds, who only contributed in creating the kernel, is today considered to be the creator of the entire Linux system. The whole ideology behind the Linux OS remains concealed from the users—that of software created free, by and for the masses. In that context, I think there is complete justification in calling the system GNU/Linux to give credit where it is due.

Baishampayan Ghose, Free Software Foundation, India
Via e-mail



digit

Dear Baishampayan,
While the collective work of GNU programmers was of paramount importance in conceiving Linux, the fact remains that singular personalities will often take the credit for a collective's blood, sweat and tears. Take the case of Microsoft—how many of us remember that Paul Allen was the co-founder of that company? Both Windows and the Redmond giant are synonymous with Bill Gates; piling credit on one individual may not be fair to others but it is a fact of life.

Game interrupted

Dear Vinit,
I've noticed a disturbing trend where every new game demands even more system resources in order to run smoothly. In my opinion, if you are a true gamer then rather than constantly upgrading your computer system, you should buy a PlayStation 2 or an Xbox gaming console. All games for these platforms run smoothly and you don't need to spend money on 'upgrading' these consoles to play any new game. Also, most games released today have versions for the Xbox and PS2.

Sushant
Via e-mail

digit

Dear Sushant,
Immersive graphics and multiplayer gaming are no longer the forte of the PC, with the current-generation game consoles having caught up in these departments. Therefore as you've rightly pointed out, if gaming is all you need to do, then buying a console makes more sense, especially considering that most games are now cross-platform. But you need not fall for the six-month upgrade cycle as no game developer is foolish enough to create and release a game that doesn't run on the majority of PCs sold in the last couple of years. Thus DOOM III when released, will run on a GeForce2-class graphics card, albeit without all the bells and whistles.

Categorise this!

Dear Vinit,
'Brilliant' is the only word that came to my mind when I got the December issue in my hand. I reside in Colombo, Sri Lanka, and every month relatives coming from Chennai get the magazine for me. Digit is an extremely useful and informative magazine and I have gained a lot from it. I base my buying decisions on your test results and as such I was hoping you would test products from categories such as DVD-RWs, FDDs, LAN cards, projectors and dish antennae, among others.

Mohammed Ameer Sahib
Via e-mail

digit

Dear Mohammed,
Whoa! Some of the categories that you have mentioned, such as DVD-RWs, are based on very nascent technologies and there aren't enough products available in the market to do a full blown comparison test. Others like LAN cards perform similarly, irrespective of brands; while floppy drives are simply dead. Even though we constantly try to add new product categories, I'm sure Digit will not be doing comparison tests on dish antennae in the near future.

digit READERS POLLS

Q. Would you replace Backbyte with a monthly technology quiz?

Yes	No	What's Back-
38%	54%	8%

Thankfully, Backbyte still finds a place in the magazine (and our readers' hearts)

Your vote counts

This month's question:

What more would you like featured in the 'Off the Shelf' section?

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote on it